GLOSSARY

Acetylecholine – A neurotransmitter found throughout the nervous system.

Acidosis – condition characterised by lower blood pH, due to the increase of keto acids (ketosis).

Acinus – Cells arranged into a circular secretory unit.

Adenosine triphosphate (ATP) – A nucleotide molecule consisting of adenine, ribose and three phosphate molecules. It plays a central role in energy exchange in biological systems.

Adipocyte – Large cell (up to 200 microns) with only a thin film of cytoplasm due to the presence of a large fat droplet.

Adipose tissue – A group of adipocytes.

Alternation of generation – Alternation of haploid sexual and diploid asexual generation in the life cycle of an animal.

Ampulla of Vater – Common duct called hepato-pancreatic duct.

Ampulla – The widened opening for each of the semicircular canals, containing sensory innervations.

Apnoea – Temporary stopping of respiration.

Berger's waves – are neural oscillations in the frequency range of 7.5–12.5 Hz arising from synchronous and coherent (in phase or constructive) electrical activity of thalamic pacemaker cells in humans.

Bicuspid valve – also called mitral valve. Left Auricular ventricular valve with two flaps that is present between the left auricle and left ventricle.

Biological indicator – refers to organisms, species or community whose characteristics show the presence of specific environmental conditions.

Bipedal – Walk or stand on two feet.

Blood pressure – (BP) is the pressure exerted by the circulating blood against the walls of blood vessels.

Book gills – Respiratory organs in aquatic Limulus.

Book lungs – Respiratory organs of Scorpions and most spiders.

Brood – a family of birds produced at one hatching or birth.

Catecholamines – Naturally occurring amines that function as neurotransmitters. They are characterised by catechol group in which an amine group is attached. Ex: Epinephrine.

Cocoon – It is a bag like structure secreted by the clitellum. Eggs and sperms are deposited into it. Fertilization and development occurs within the cocoon.

Collagen – A triple helix protein which allows for great tensile strength.

Dioecious – Animals in which male and female reproductive organs occur in separate individuals.

Drilosphere – is the part of the soil influenced by earthworm secretions, burrowing and castings.

Dyspnoea – painful respiration.

Electromagnetic (EM) radiation – Electromagnetic radiation is a form of energy that is all around us and takes many forms, such as radio waves, microwaves, X-rays and gamma rays.

Evisceration (Autotomy) - Ejection of viscera as a defensive action by an animal.

Falciform ligament – Sickle shaped thin fibrous structure that connects the liver with diaphragm.

Functional Respiratory Capacity (FRC) - Volume of air present after expiration in lungs.

Goblet cell – special mucus secreting columnar epithelial cell located in the respiratory tract and intestine.

Hypopharynx – The hypopharynx is a somewhat globular structure, located medially to the mandibles and the maxillae. In many species it is membranous and associated with salivary glands. It assists in swallowing the food.

Hypoxia – the failure of tissues for any reason to receive an adequate supply of oxygen.

Incubator – is a device used to grow and maintain microbiological cultures or cell cultures. and maintains optimal temperature, humidity and other conditions such as the carbon dioxide (CO_2) and oxygen content of the atmosphere inside.

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